The document and process conversion measures necessary to comply with this revision shall be completed by 1 May 2005.

METRIC

MIL-PRF-31032/4A
29 October 2004
SUPERSEDING
MIL-PRF-31032/4
31 December 1999

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION SHEET

PRINTED WIRING BOARD, RIGID FLEX OR FLEXIBLE, MULTILAYER, WITH PLATED HOLES, WITH OR WITHOUT STIFFENERS, FOR SOLDERED PART MOUNTING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-PRF-31032.

1. SCOPE

* 1.1 Scope. This specification covers the generic performance requirements for multilayered (three or more conductor layers) rigid-flex or flexible (with or without stiffeners) printed wiring boards (hereafter designated printed board) with plated holes that will use soldering for component/part mounting (see 6.1.1).

* 1.2 Classification. Printed boards covered by this specification sheet are classified by the following types and installation uses.

* 1.2.1 Types. The printed board types are classified as follows, as specified (see 6.2).

Type 3 - Multilayer flexible printed board.

Type 4 - Multilayer rigid-flex printed board.

* 1.2.2 Installation uses. The following installation uses describe the possible usage/application of the printed boards (see 6.2.e).

* Use A - The rigid-flex or flexible printed board is capable of withstanding flexing during installation (flex-to-install).

* Use B - Portions of the rigid-flex or flexible printed board are capable of withstanding continuous flexing (dynamic flex) for a number of cycles specified in the printed board procurement documentation (see 6.2.1.c).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3, 4, or 5 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3, 4, or 5 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

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* 2.2 Government documents. The following specification forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-PRF-31032 - Printed Circuit Board/Printed Wiring Board, General Specification for.

* (Copies of these documents are available online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/quicksearch/ or www.dodssp.daps.mil or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

* 2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL (ASTM)

ASTM E345 - Standard Test Methods of Tension Testing of Metallic Foil.

* (Application for copies should be addressed to the ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, P. O. Box C700, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959 or http://www.astm.org.)

* IPC - ASSOCIATION CONNECTING ELECTRONICS INDUSTRIES (IPC)

J-STD-003 - Solderability Tests for Printed Boards.
IPC-2221 - Generic Standard on Printed Board Design.
IPC-2223 - Sectional Design Standard for Flexible Printed Boards.
IPC-TM-650 - Test Methods Manual.

* (Application for copies should be addressed to IPC - Association Connecting Electronics Industry, 3000 Lakeside Drive, Suite 309 S, Bannockburn, IL 60015-1249 or http://www.ipc.org.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Printed board detail requirements. Printed boards delivered under this specification shall be in accordance with the requirements as specified herein, and documented in the printed board procurement documentation.

3.1.1 Conflicting requirements. The order of precedence of conflicting requirements shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032.

3.1.2 Reference to printed board procurement documentation. For the purposes of this specification, when the term "specified" is used without additional reference to a specific location or document, the intended reference shall be to the applicable printed board procurement documentation.

3.2 Qualification. Printed boards furnished under this specification shall be technologies that are manufactured by a manufacturer authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified manufacturers list before contract award (see 4.2 and 6.3).

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* 3.3 Design (see 3.1 and 6.2). Printed boards shall be of the design specified. Unless otherwise noted herein, if individual design parameters are not specified in the printed board procurement documentation, then the baseline design parameters shall be as specified as follows:

* a. Overall printed board design baseline shall be in accordance with IPC-2223, performance class 3.

* b. Test coupons design, quantity, placement, and usage shall be in accordance with IPC-2221, performance class 3. Test coupons shall be as specified in the applicable design standard and shall reflect worst-case design conditions of the printed boards that they represent.

* 3.4 Printed board materials. All materials used in the construction of compliant printed boards shall comply with the applicable specifications referenced in the printed board procurement documentation. If materials used in the production of printed boards are not specified, then it is the manufacturer's responsibility to use materials which will meet the performance requirements of this specification sheet. Acceptance or approval of any printed board material shall not be construed as a guarantee of the acceptance of the completed printed board.

* 3.5 External visual and dimensional requirements. Printed board test specimens (the finished printed boards or supporting test coupons, as applicable) shall conform to the requirements specified in 3.5.1 through 3.5.9, as applicable.

3.5.1 Base material.

* 3.5.1.1 Edges of flexible base material. The trimmed edge of completed printed boards shall be free of defects such as burrs, delaminations, nicks, or tears in excess of those allowed in 3.5.1.2 and 3.5.1.3. Following the solderability or thermal stress test, discolorations or resin recession at completed or trimmed edges of the flexible base material shall be acceptable provided that the discoloration or resin recession defect does not reduce the edge spacing below the specified requirements.

* 3.5.1.2 Edges of rigid base material. Burrs, chips, delaminations, haloing, nicks, and other penetrations along the rigid base material edges of completed printed boards shall be acceptable provided the defect does not reduce the edge spacing specified by more than 50 percent.

* 3.5.1.3 Surface imperfections. Surface imperfections (such as cuts, dents, pits, scratches, or exposed reinforcement material fibers) shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

* a. The imperfections do not bridge between conductors.

b. The dielectric spacing between the imperfection and a conductor is not reduced below the specified minimum conductor spacing requirements.

* 3.5.1.4 Subsurface imperfections. Subsurface imperfections (such as adhesive voids, blistering, delamination, foreign inclusions, haloing, etc.) shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. The imperfections do not bridge more than 25 percent of the distance between access holes, conductors, or plated-through holes. No more than two percent of the printed board area on each side shall be affected.

b. The imperfections do not reduce conductor or dielectric spacing below the specified minimum requirements.

c. The imperfections do not propagate as a result of testing (such as rework simulation, thermal stress, or thermal shock).

d. The longest dimension of any single imperfection is no greater than 0.80 mm (.032 inch). In non-circuitry areas, the maximum size shall not be greater than 2.00 mm (.079 inch) in the longest dimension or 0.01 percent of the printed board area, maximum.

* e. Following the solderability or thermal stress test, discoloration or resin recession shall be acceptable at access hole edges provided that they do not reduce the edge spacing below the specified requirements.

NOTE: Color variations or mottled appearance in bond enhancement treatments shall be acceptable.

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3.5.2 Conductor pattern.

* 3.5.2.1 Annular ring, external. The external annular ring shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, the external annular ring may have, in isolated areas, a 20 percent reduction of the specified external annular ring due to defects such as pits, dents, nicks, or pinholes.

* 3.5.2.1.1 Solderable component lands. Unless otherwise specified, the external annular ring may have in isolated areas a 20 percent reduction of the specified minimum external annular ring due to defects such coverlayer (see 3.5.3.1) or stiffener (see 3.5.9) access hole misregistration. No more than 20 percent of the annular ring circumference (72 degrees) may be affected.

3.5.2.1.2 Adhesive on lands of solderable plated-through holes. Unless otherwise specified, the minimum external annular ring for solderable plated-through holes shall not be reduced by more than 10 percent due to adhesives extruded onto lands.

3.5.2.1.3 Adhesive on lands of unsupported holes. Unless otherwise specified, the minimum external annular ring for solderable unsupported holes shall not be reduced by more than 20 percent due to adhesives extruded onto lands.

* 3.5.2.2 Bonding of conductor to base material and lifted lands. There shall be no peeling or lifting of any conductor pattern or land from the base material. The completed printed board shall not exhibit any lifted land. (NOTE: See 3.6.12 for allowances for the acceptable lifting of terminal pads, i.e. lifted lands, following the thermal stress test, rework simulation, and thermal shock testing.)

* 3.5.2.3 Conductor imperfections. The conductor pattern shall contain no cracks, splits, or tears. Unless otherwise specified, any combination of edge roughness, nicks, pinholes, cuts, or scratches exposing the base material shall not reduce each conductor width by more than 20 percent of its minimum specified width. There shall be no occurrence of the 20 percent reductions greater than 13.0 mm (.51 inch) or 10 percent of a conductor length, whichever is less.

* 3.5.2.4 Conductor finish (plating or coating). The conductor finish shall be as specified.

3.5.2.4.1 Coverage. The conductor finish shall completely cover the exposed conductor pattern. Complete coverage does not apply to the vertical conductor edges.

3.5.2.4.2 Whiskers. There shall be no whiskers of solder or other platings on the surface of the conductor pattern.

3.5.2.5 Conductor spacing. Conductor spacing shall be as specified.

3.5.2.6 Conductor width. Conductor width shall be as specified.

3.5.3 Coverlayer.

3.5.3.1 Access hole registration. The coverlayer registration shall be such that the size or diameter of the access hole shall not reduce the component land area or minimum annular ring below the limits specified (see 3.5.2.1). Misregistration of the coverlayer shall not expose adjacent isolated conductors or lands.

3.5.3.2 Delamination. There shall be no coverlayer delamination along the outer edges of the coverlayer. Coverlayer delamination shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

* a. At random locations away from conductors if each delamination is no larger than 6.45 square mm (.010 square inch), and is not within 1.0 mm (.040 inch) of the printed board edge or an access hole edge. The total number of the above delaminations shall not exceed three in any 645 square mm (1.0 square inch) of coverlayer surface area.

b. Along conductor edges, the total delamination does not exceed either 0.051 mm (.02 inch) in width or 20 percent of the spacing between adjacent conductors, whichever is smaller.

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* 3.5.3.2.1 Delamination after flexibility endurance or folding flexibility testing. After exposure to the flexibility endurance test (see 3.7.4.5 and 4.7.4.5) or folding flexibility test (see 3.7.4.6 and 4.7.4.6), there shall be no propagation of any coverlayer delamination in the flex area.

3.5.3.3 Solder wicking. Wicking of solder under the coverlayer shall be acceptable provided the conductor spacing requirements are met.

3.5.3.4 Wrinkles or creases. Wrinkles or creases in the coverlayer shall be acceptable provided the requirements of 3.5.3.2 are met.

* 3.5.4 Dimensions. The completed printed board shall meet the dimensional requirements (such as cutouts, overall thickness, periphery, etc.) specified.

3.5.5 Hole pattern accuracy. The size and location of the hole pattern in the printed board shall be as specified.

* 3.5.6 Lifted lands. The finished printed board shall exhibit any lifted lands.

3.5.7 Solder resist. Unless otherwise specified, the solder resist conditions below shall apply.

* 3.5.7.1 Coverage. Solder resist coverage imperfections (such as blisters, skips, and voids) shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

* a. The solder resist imperfection shall not expose two adjacent conductors whose spacing is less than the electrical spacing required for the voltage range and environmental condition specified in the applicable design standard.

b. In areas containing parallel conductors, the solder resist imperfection shall not expose two isolated conductors whose spacing is less than 0.5 mm (.02 inch) unless one of the conductors is a test point or other feature area which is purposely left uncoated for subsequent operations.

c. The exposed conductor shall not be bare copper.

d. The solder resist imperfection does not expose tented via holes.

3.5.7.2 Discoloration. Discoloration of metallic surfaces under the cured solder resist is acceptable.

3.5.7.3 Registration. The solder resist shall be registered to the land or terminal patterns in such a manner as to meet the requirements specified. If no requirements are specified, the following apply:

a. Unless otherwise specified, solder resist shall not encroach onto surface mount lands.

b. Solder resist misregistration onto plated-through component hole lands (plated-through holes to which solder connections are to be made) shall not reduce the external annular ring below the specified minimum requirements.

c. Solder resist shall not encroach into plated-through hole barrels or onto other surface features (such as connector fingers or lands of unplated holes) to which solder connections will be made.

* d. Solder resist is permitted in plated-through holes or vias in which no lead is to be soldered.

e. Test points which are intended for assembly testing shall be free of solder resist unless a partial coverage allowance is specified.

3.5.7.4 Thickness. Solder resist thickness shall be as specified.

* 3.5.7.5 Solder resist cure. The cured solder resist coating shall not exhibit tackiness, blistering, or delamination.

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3.5.8 Stiffeners (see 6.7). The design, placement, and acceptability requirements for stiffeners shall be as specified.

3.5.9 Stiffener access hole registration. Stiffener access hole registration shall be such that the size or diameter of the access hole shall not reduce the component land area or minimum annular ring below the limits specified (see 3.5.2.1.1).

* 3.6 Microsection requirements. Printed board test specimens (production printed boards or test coupons) shall conform to the requirements in 3.6.1 through 3.6.12, as applicable (see figure 1). Blind and buried vias shall meet the requirements of plated-through holes.

3.6.1 Annular ring, internal. The minimum internal annular ring shall be as specified.

* 3.6.2 Conductor finish thickness (plating or coating). The plating or coating thickness of the conductor finish shall be as specified.

* 3.6.3 Conductor thickness. The conductor thickness shall be as specified (see 3.1).

* 3.6.3.1 Minimum external thickness and internal sequentially plated layer thickness. When a conductor thickness is specified, the external conductor thickness (copper foil and copper plating) shall be equal to or greater than the specified thickness. When a conductor thickness with tolerance is specified, the external conductor thickness shall be within the specified tolerance for the specified thickness.

* 3.6.3.2 Minimum internal thickness (multilayered). When the procurement documentation specifies a minimum conductor thickness for internal conductors, the resulting conductor shall be equal to or within the specified tolerance for the specified conductor thickness. If only a copper foil weight requirement is specified, a reduction in thickness up to 10 percent for deposited metal foil types or 5 percent for wrought or rolled metal foil types below the minimum allowable foil thickness specified by the applicable material specification shall be considered acceptable in order to accommodate a processing allowance for cleaning either by chemical or mechanical means.

* 3.6.4 Hole wall plating.

3.6.4.1 Copper plating thickness. Unless otherwise specified, the copper plating thickness shall be in accordance with the applicable design standard. Any copper plating thickness less than 80 percent of the specified thickness shall be treated as a void.

3.6.4.1.1 Copper plating voids. The copper plating in the plated-through hole shall not exhibit any void in excess of the following:

a. There shall be no more than one plating void per panel, regardless of length or size.

b. There shall be no plating void longer than five percent of the total printed board thickness.

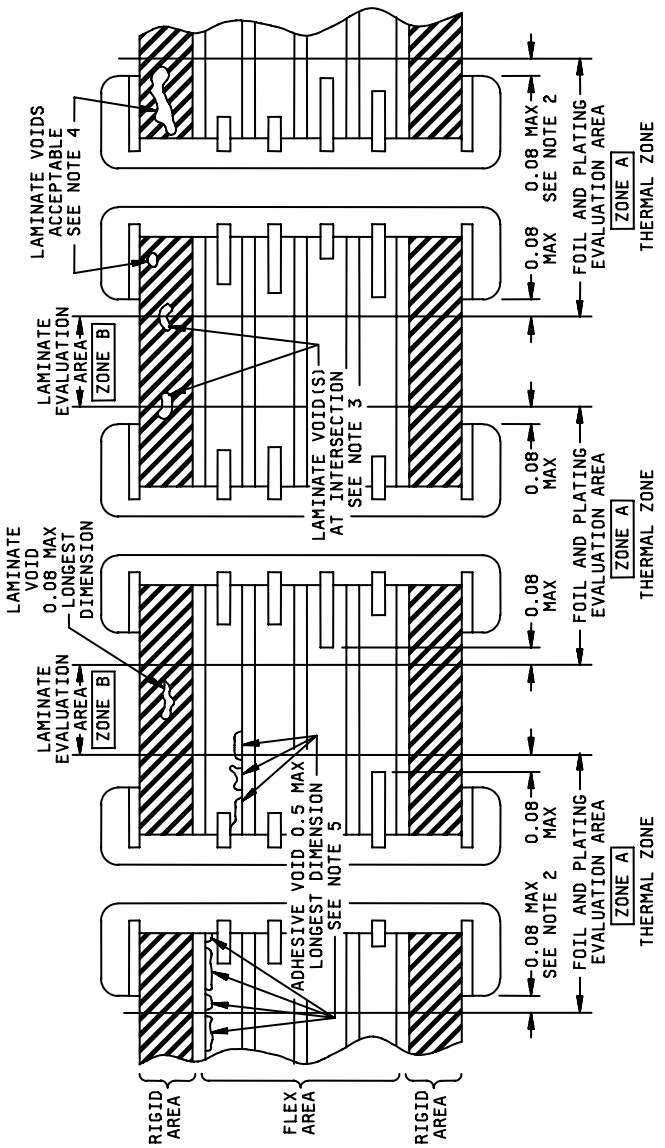
* c. There shall be no plating voids evident at the interface of any conductive layer and plated hole wall.

Conductor finish plating or coating material between the base material and copper plating (i.e., behind the hole wall copper plating) is evidence of a void. Any plated hole exhibiting this condition shall be counted as having one void for panel acceptance purposes.

* 3.6.4.2 Copper plating defects. Nodules, plating folds, plating inclusions, or plated reinforcement material protrusions that project into the plated-through hole shall be acceptable provided that the hole diameter and the copper thickness are not reduced below their specified limits. Plating folds are allowed when closed.

* 3.6.4.3 Wicking. Wicking of copper plating extending 0.08 mm (.003 inch) into the base material shall be acceptable provided it does not reduce the conductor spacing below the minimum clearance spacing requirements specified.

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NOTES:
1. Dimensions are in millimeters.
2. Typically beyond land edge most radially extended.
3. Voids at intersection of zone A and zone B. Laminate voids greater than 0.08 (.0031 inch) that extend into zone B are rejectable.
4. Laminate voids are not evaluated in zone A.
5. Multiple adhesive voids between two adjacent plated-through holes in the same plane shall not have a combined length exceeding 0.5 mm (.02 inch).

* FIGURE 1. Typical plated-through hole cross section after thermal stress or rework simulation.

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* 3.6.5 Metallic cracks. There shall be no cracks in the platings, coatings, or internal conductive foils. Cracks are permissible in the external layer (outer) copper foil provided they do not extend into the plated copper.

* 3.6.6 Dielectric layer thickness (layer-to-layer separation). The minimum dielectric thickness between conductor layers shall be as specified.

3.6.7 Etchback (when specified, see 3.1). When specified, printed boards shall be etched back for the lateral removal of base material (resin, reinforcement material, etc.) from the internal conductors prior to plating. The etchback shall be effective on at least the top or bottom surface of each internal conductor. Negative etchback is not acceptable when etchback is specified.

* 3.6.7.1 Etchback limits. Unless otherwise specified, the etchback shall be 0.005 mm (.0002 inch) minimum and 0.076 mm (.003 inch) maximum when measured at the internal copper contact area protrusion.

* 3.6.8 Smear removal. The plated through hole internal conductor shall be cleaned to be free of resin smear. When etchback is not specified, a negative etchback of 0.013 mm (.0005 inch) maximum shall be acceptable.

3.6.9 Conductive interface separations. Except for along the vertical edge of the external copper foil, there shall be no separations or contamination between the hole wall conductive interfaces. Conductive interface separations along the vertical edge of the external copper foil shall be acceptable. Anomalies resulting from this separation shall not be cause for rejection.

* NOTE: The term conductive interfaces shall be used to describe the junction between the hole wall plating or coating and the surfaces of internal and external layers of copper or metal foil. The interface between platings and coating (electroless copper, direct metallization copper, and non-electroless electroless copper substitutes, etc., and electrolytic copper, whether panel or pattern plated) shall also be considered a conductive interface.

* 3.6.10 Laminate voids. Laminate voids with the longest dimension of 0.08 mm (.003 inch) or less shall be acceptable provided the conductor spacing is not reduced below the minimum dielectric spacing requirements, laterally or vertically, as specified. After undergoing rework simulation (see 3.7.4.7), thermal stress (see 3.7.6.2) or thermal shock (see 3.7.6.3), laminate voids are not evaluated in zone A (see figure 1).

* 3.6.11 Adhesive voids (when applicable). Adhesive voids in the flexible metal clad base material no greater than 0.5 mm (.02 inch) or 25 percent of conductor spacing, whichever is less, shall be acceptable. Multiple adhesive voids in the same plane between adjacent plated holes shall not have a combined length which exceeds .5 mm (.02 inch)

* 3.6.12 Lifted lands (after thermal stress, rework simulation, or thermal shock). After undergoing rework simulation (see 3.7.4.7), thermal stress (see 3.7.6.2), or thermal shock (see 3.7.6.3), the maximum allowed lifted land distance from the printed board surface plane to the outer lower edge of the land shall be the thickness (height) of the terminal area or land. The completed, non-stressed printed board shall not exhibit any lifted lands.

* 3.7 Performance requirements. The performance requirements specified in 3.7.1 through 3.7.6.3 shall be verified by the test methods detailed in 4.7. Unless otherwise specified by the Technical Review Board (TRB), test optimization in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032 may be used, but the printed boards shall meet all of the performance requirements specified and herein, regardless of the verification method used.

* 3.7.1 Acceptability (of printed boards). When examined as specified in 4.7.1, the printed boards shall conform to the acceptance requirements specified in 3.3 (design), 3.4 (material), 3.5 (external visual and dimensional), 3.8 (marking), and 3.9 (workmanship), inclusive.

* 3.7.2 Microsection evaluation (of printed board test specimens). When printed board test specimens (completed printed boards, supporting test coupons, or qualification test specimens) are microsectioned and examined as specified in 4.7.2, the requirements specified in 3.6 shall be met.

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3.7.3 Chemical requirements.

3.7.3.1 Cleanliness. When printed board test specimens are tested in accordance with 4.7.3.1, the levels of cleanliness shall be in accordance with the requirements of 3.7.3.1.1 or 3.7.3.1.2, as applicable.

3.7.3.1.1 Prior to the application of solder resist. Unless otherwise specified, prior to the application of solder resist, the level of ionic contamination shall not exceed 1.56 micrograms/square centimeter (10.06 micrograms/square inch).

3.7.3.1.2 Completed printed boards (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2.1.a). The levels of cleanliness for completed printed boards shall be as specified.

3.7.3.2 Copper plating characteristics.

* 3.7.3.2.1 Elongation. When copper plating is tested in accordance with 4.7.3.2, the elongation shall be 12 percent minimum.

3.7.3.2.2 Tensile strength. When copper plating is tested in accordance with 4.7.3.3, the tensile strength shall be 248 MPa (36,000 psi) minimum.

3.7.4 Physical requirements.

* 3.7.4.1 Adhesion, marking. After marking is tested in accordance with 4.7.4.1, any specified markings which are missing in whole or in part, faded, shifted (dislodged), or smeared to the extent that it is no longer legible shall constitute failure. A slight change in the color of ink or paint markings after the test shall be acceptable.

* 3.7.4.2 Adhesion, plating. When tested as specified in 4.7.4.2, there shall be no part of the conductor pattern or copper plating protective finish (coating or plating) removed from the printed board test specimen except for those related to outgrowth, overhang, or slivers.

3.7.4.3 Adhesion, solder resist (when applicable). When tested as specified in 4.7.4.3, the maximum percentage of cured solder resist lifted from the surface of the base material, conductors, and lands of the coated printed board test specimen shall not exceed the following limits:

a. Bare copper or base material: 0 percent.

b. Non-melting metals (e.g., gold or nickel plating): 5 percent.

c. Melting metals (e.g., tin-lead plating, solder coating, indium, bismuth, etc.): 10 percent.

3.7.4.4 Bow and twist (Type 4 and designs with stiffener and bow and twist limits)(see 6.2.1.b). When printed boards are tested as specified in 4.7.4.4, the maximum limit for bow and twist shall be as specified.

* 3.7.4.5 Flexibility endurance (use B only). When tested as specified in 4.7.4.5, the printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the specified conditions of 3.7.4.5.1 or 3.7.4.5.2, as applicable, without any evidence of damage, degradation or rejectable delamination. After the test, the requirements specified in 3.7.5.1 and 3.7.5.2 shall be met.

3.7.4.5.1 Qualification and periodic testing. A single sided (type 1) printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding 100,000 cycles.

* 3.7.4.5.2 Acquiring activity specified (see 6.2.1.c). The test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the flexing for the number of flexing cycles, flexing rate, and points of application specified.

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3.7.4.6 Folding flexibility. When tested as specified in 4.7.4.6, printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the specified conditions of 3.7.4.6.1 or 3.7.4.6.2, as applicable, without any evidence of damage, degradation or rejectable delamination. After the test, the requirements specified in 3.5.3, 3.7.5.1, and 3.7.5.2 shall be met.

3.7.4.6.1 Qualification and periodic testing. The baseline parameters for qualification and periodic testing shall be as follows:

a. Direction of bend: Both directions (sides).

b. Degree of bend: 180 degrees.

c. Point of application: Center of test specimen.

d. Number of fold cycles: 25.

* 3.7.4.6.2 Acquiring activity specified (see 6.2.1.d). The printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the folding for the direction of bend, degree of bend, points of application, number of fold cycles, and diameter of mandrel specified.

* 3.7.4.7 Rework simulation. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.7, the printed board test specimens shall be microsectioned and inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and the requirements specified in 3.6 shall be met.

* 3.7.4.8 Solderability (see 6.2.1.b). When required by the procurement documentation, accelerated conditioning for coating durability shall be in accordance with J-STD-003.

3.7.4.8.1 Hole solderability. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.8, the printed board test specimen shall conform to the class 3 acceptance criteria specified in J-STD-003.

3.7.4.8.2 Surface solderability. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.8, the printed board test specimen shall conform to the class 3 acceptance criteria specified in J-STD-003.

3.7.5 Electrical requirements.

3.7.5.1 Continuity. When tested in accordance with 4.7.5.1, unless otherwise specified, there shall be no circuit whose resistance exceeds 10 ohms. For referee purposes, 0.5 ohm maximum per 25.0 mm (.98 inch) of circuit length shall apply.

3.7.5.2 Isolation (circuit shorts). When tested as specified in 4.7.5.2, the resistance between mutually isolated conductors shall be greater than 100 megohms.

3.7.6 Environmental requirements.

3.7.6.1 Moisture and insulation resistance. When tested as specified in 4.7.6.1, the printed board test specimen shall have a minimum of 500 megohms of resistance between conductors. After the test, the printed board test specimen shall not exhibit blistering, measling, or delamination in excess of that allowed in 3.5.1 and 3.5.3.

* 3.7.6.2 Thermal stress. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.2, the printed board test specimen shall be inspected in accordance with 4.7.1 and shall meet the requirements of 3.5.1.1 and 3.5.1.4. The test specimen shall then be inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and shall meet the requirements of 3.6.

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3.7.6.3 Thermal shock. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.3, the printed board test specimens shall meet the following requirements:

a. Visual inspection: When inspected as specified in 4.7.1, there shall be no evidence of plating cracks, blistering, crazing, or delamination in excess of that allowed in 3.5.

* b. Resistance change: The change in resistance between the first high temperature cycle and the last high temperature cycle shall not be more than 10 percent.

c. Microsection: The printed board test specimen shall be microsectioned and inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and the requirements specified in 3.6 shall be met.

3.8 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032.

* 3.9 Workmanship. Printed boards shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from defects that will affect life, serviceability, or appearance.

4. VERIFICATION

* 4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

* a. Qualification inspection (see 4.2).

* b. Conformance inspection (see 4.3 and tables I and II).

* c. Capability verification inspection (see 4.6).

4.1.1 Sampling and inspection. Sampling and inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032, and as specified herein.

4.1.2 Standard test and inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified by the applicable test method or procedure, inspections and tests may be performed at ambient conditions.

4.2 Qualification inspection. Unless otherwise specified by the TRB approved qualification test plan, qualification inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032 and as specified herein.

4.2.1 Qualification test vehicles. The qualification test vehicle(s) to be subjected to qualification inspection shall be in accordance with the TRB approved qualification test plan and the applicable qualification test vehicle specification(s).

4.2.1.1 Sample. The number of qualification test vehicle(s) to be subjected to qualification inspection shall be in accordance with TRB approved qualification test plan.

* 4.2.2 Test routine. The qualification test vehicle(s) shall be subjected to the inspections and tests specified in tables I and II in addition to thermal shock in accordance with 3.7.6.3 and 4.7.6.3.

* 4.2.3 Qualification by similarity. A production lot may be considered qualified by similarity if the dimensional parameters are within twenty-five percent of those currently qualified and the processing steps used are a set or subset of those processes used for a previous qualified technology.

* 4.3 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032 and shall consist of lot conformance inspection (see 4.4) and periodic conformance inspection (see 4.5).

* 4.4 Lot conformance inspection. Lot conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032 and table I herein. Panels and printed boards to be delivered in accordance with this specification shall have been subjected to and passed all applicable inspections and tests of table I prior to delivery of product. Lot conformance inspection testing by subgroup or within a subgroup may be performed in any sequence.

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* TABLE I. Lot conformance inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph	Specimen to test 1/				Sample plan 2/
			PWB	THM	SMT	MIX	
Subgroup 1 (panel acceptance)							
* Thermal stress	3.7.6.2	4.7.6.2		A & B	A & B	A & B	See 4.4.1.1
Subgroup 2 (100 percent)							
Continuity	3.7.5.1	4.7.5.1	X				100 percent 3/
Isolation (circuit shorts)	3.7.5.2	4.7.5.2	X				100 percent 3/
Subgroup 3a (Sample)							
Acceptability: 4/ 5/	3.7.1	4.7.1	X				Plan BF
Subgroup 3b (Sample)							
Chemical:							
Cleanliness 6/	3.7.3.1.1	4.7.3.1	X				Plan BN or TN 7/
Subgroup 3c (Sample)							
Physical:							
Adhesion, marking	3.7.4.1	4.7.4.1	X	8/	8/	8/	Plan BF or TJ 7/
Adhesion, plating 9/	3.7.4.2	4.7.4.2	X	C	C	C	Plan BF or TJ 7/
Adhesion, solder resist	3.7.4.3	4.7.4.3	X	G	G 10/	G 10/	Plan BF or TJ 7/
Bow and twist	3.7.4.4	4.7.4.4	X				Plan BH
Solderability							
Hole	3.7.4.8.1	4.7.4.8		S or A		A or S	Plan TJ
Surface	3.7.4.8.2	4.7.4.8			C or M	C or M	Plan TJ

* 1/ Unless otherwise specified, test coupons are in accordance with IPC-2221. PWB is a production board; THM is a through-hole mount PWB test coupon; SMT is a surface mount PWB test coupon; MIX is for printed board designs containing both through-hole and surface mount components test coupon.

2/ See MIL-PRF-31032 for C = 0 sampling plans.

* 3/ At the acquiring activity's option for designs that will have only connectors joined to the completed assembly, electrical testing can be performed at the assembly level (see 6.2.1.f).

4/ Design (3.3), conductor spacing (3.5.2.5), conductor width (3.5.2.7), conductor imperfections (3.5.2.3) and workmanship (3.9) shall be inspected on both the internal layers containing conductors prior to lamination and the completed printed board.

5/ Surface imperfections (3.5.1.2) and subsurface imperfections (3.5.1.3) shall be inspected prior to solder resist application.

* 6/ Inspection shall be performed prior to solder resist application. Additional inspections on completed printed boards may be specified.

* 7/ Test coupon, production panel, or production printed board, manufacturer option.

8/ See 4.7.4.1 for test specimen description and quantity.

* 9/ All surface platings and coatings shall be inspected.

10/ Test coupon T shall be used when production printed boards have tented via holes.

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* 4.4.1 Subgroup 1 (panel acceptance). The panel acceptance test shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032, and as specified in table I, subgroup 1.

* 4.4.1.1 Sampling. A minimum of two test coupons (one A and one B test coupon) per completed panel shall be tested. The two test coupons shall be taken from opposite corners of the panel. After the test, one of the test coupons shall be microsectioned in the panel's length (X direction) and the other shall be microsectioned along the panel's width (Y direction).

4.4.1.3 Percent defective allowable (PDA) limits. The PDA limits for panel acceptance shall be 32 percent.

* 4.4.1.4 Failure mode observations. If the microsection evaluation results indicate a potential failure mode in the non-stressed printed board test specimens (i.e., propagation of subsurface imperfections, lifted lands within post-thermal stress acceptance criteria, etc.), additional microsection examination of non-stressed test specimens shall be performed.

4.4.2 Subgroup 2 inspections (100 percent inspections). The subgroup 2 inspections shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032, and as specified in table I, subgroup 2.

* 4.4.2.1 PDA limits. The PDA limits for subgroup 2 inspections shall be 50 percent.

* 4.4.3 Subgroup 3 inspections (sample). Panels and printed boards to be delivered in accordance with this specification shall have been subjected to and passed all the inspections of table I, subgroups 3a, 3b, and 3c.

4.4.3.1 Sampling. A sample of printed boards (or test coupons that represent the printed boards) shall be randomly selected from each inspection lot.

* 4.4.3.2 PDA limits. When 100 percent of a production lot is inspected, either in lieu of sampling or due to rejection of a sample inspection lot, the PDA limits for this 100 percent inspection shall be 50 percent.

* 4.5 Periodic conformance inspection. Periodic conformance inspection shall be in accordance with TRB approved periodic conformance inspection plan or table II herein.

* TABLE II. Periodic conformance inspection baseline test coverage.

Inspection 1/	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph	Frequency
Elongation Tensile strength	3.7.3.2.1 3.7.3.2.2	4.7.3.2 4.7.3.3	Monthly Monthly
Flexibility endurance Folding flexibility	3.7.4.5 3.7.4.6	4.7.4.5 4.7.4.6	Annually Annually
Rework simulation Moisture and insulation resistance	3.7.4.7 3.7.6.1	4.7.4.7 4.7.6.1	Monthly Monthly

* 1/ A minimum of two test specimens per inspection.

* 4.6 Capability verification inspection. Capability verification inspection shall be in accordance with the TRB approved capability verification inspection plan. The frequency of this verification shall be as a minimum every 2 years. Each base material type qualified shall be verified. The following tests and inspections should be considered when accomplishing capability verification inspection: thermal shock, rework simulation, and moisture and insulation resistance testing.

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4.7 Methods of inspection.

4.7.1 Visual and dimensional inspection. The printed board specimen shall be inspected in accordance with test method number 2.1.8 of IPC-TM-650, except that the magnification shall be 1.75x (3 diopters), minimum.

* 4.7.2 Microsection inspection. Microsection inspections shall be accomplished by using methods in accordance with either test method number 2.1.1 or 2.1.1.2 of IPC-TM-650. The plated-through holes shall be microsectioned in the vertical plane with an accuracy of +/- 10 percent of the center of the hole. A minimum of three holes shall be evaluated per microsection.

4.7.3 Chemical test methods.

* 4.7.3.1 Cleanliness. The printed board specimen shall be inspected for ionic cleanliness in accordance with test method number 2.3.25 of IPC-TM-650.

* 4.7.3.2 Elongation of copper. The test for elongation of copper shall be performed in accordance with ASTM E345 or test method number 2.4.18.1 of IPC-TM-650. The travel speed of testing shall be 50.0 mm ± 1.0 mm (1.97 ± .03 inches) per minute.

* 4.7.3.3 Tensile strength of copper. The test for tensile strength of copper shall be performed in accordance with ASTM E345 or test method number 2.4.18.1 of IPC-TM-650. The travel speed of testing shall be 50.0 mm ± 1.0 mm (1.97 ± .03 inches) per minute.

4.7.4 Physical test methods.

4.7.4.1 Adhesion, marking. Test specimens which represent all types of marking used on the lot (except etched marking) shall be subjected to the solderability test in 4.7.4.8. The side of the test specimen that is marked shall be placed against the solder. After the test, the test specimen shall be examined in accordance with 4.7.1 and the requirements of 3.7.4.1 shall be met.

4.7.4.2 Adhesion, plating. The test for plating adhesion shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.1 of IPC-TM-650.

4.7.4.3 Adhesion, solder resist. The test for solder resist adhesion shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.28.1 of IPC-TM-650.

4.7.4.4 Bow and twist. The tests for bow and twist shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.22 of IPC-TM-650.

4.7.4.5 Flexibility endurance.

4.7.4.5.1 Qualification and periodic tests. The flexibility endurance test shall be in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC-TM-650. The following exceptions shall apply:

a. Test specimen: Test specimens shall be production designs or test coupon in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC-TM-650.

b. Number of flex cycles: 100,000.

c. Diameter of mandrel. The diameter of the mandrel shall be twelve times the sum of the total ply thickness reduced to the nearest 2.50 mm (.098 inch).

d. Flexing rate: 0.3 seconds per cycle minimum.

e. Travel of loop (when applicable): 30.0 mm (1.18 inch) minimum.

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4.7.4.5.2 Acquiring activity specified. The flexibility endurance test shall be in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC-TM-650. The following details shall be specified (see 6.2.1.c):

a. Number of flex cycles.

b. Diameter of mandrel.

c. Flexing rate.

d. The length of travel of loop.

4.7.4.6 Folding flexibility.

4.7.4.6.1 Qualification and periodic tests. The folding flexibility test shall be performed in accordance with 4.7.4.6.3 and figure 2.

4.7.4.6.2 Acquiring activity specified. The folding flexibility test shall be performed in accordance with 4.7.4.6.3 and figure 2. The following details shall be specified (see 6.2.1.d):

a. Direction of bend (detail A in figure 2).

b. Degree of bend (detail B in figure 2).

c. Points of application (detail C in figure 2).

d. Diameter of mandrel (detail D in figure 2): The diameter of mandrel shall be twelve times overall material thickness, reduced to the nearest 2.50 mm (.098 inch).

e. Number of fold cycles.

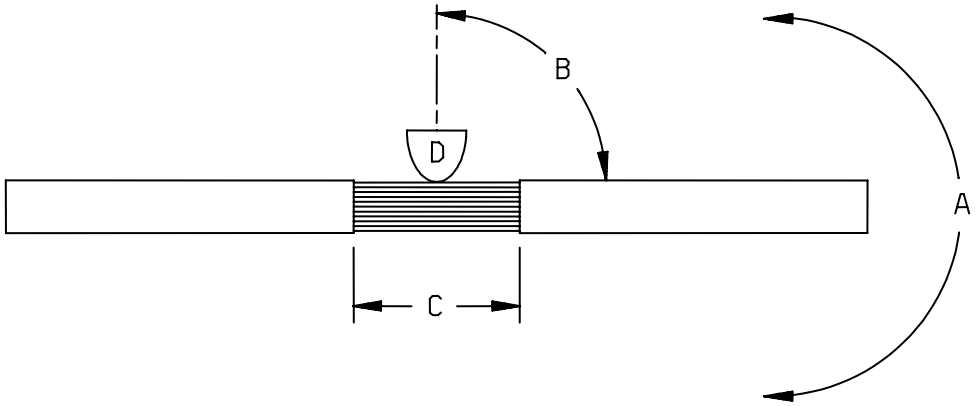


FIGURE 2. Folding flexibility test.

4.7.4.6.3 Fold cycle. A fold cycle shall be defined as taking one end of the specimen and folding it around a mandrel and then unfold back to the original starting position, traveling 180 degrees in one direction and 180 degrees in the opposite direction. A fold cycle may also be defined as folding (using opposite ends) the ends toward each other (fold the same direction) and then unfold back to the original starting position, with each end traveling 90 degrees in one direction and 90 degrees in the opposite direction. The specified number of fold cycles shall be performed with the mandrel placed in contact with the specimen on one side and then again with the mandrel placed in contact with the specimen on the opposite side.

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4.7.4.7 Rework simulation. The rework simulation test shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.36 of IPC-TM-650.

* 4.7.4.8 Solderability. The tests for hole or surface solderability shall be performed in accordance with J-STD-003. When required by the procurement documentation, accelerated conditioning for coating durability shall be in accordance with J-STD-003. The default category of coating durability of J-STD-003 is category 2.

4.7.5 Electrical test methods.

4.7.5.1 Continuity. A current shall be passed through each conductor or group of interconnected conductors by applying electrodes on the terminals at each end of the conductor or group of conductors. The current passed through the conductors shall not exceed those specified in the applicable design standard for the smallest conductor in the circuit.

* 4.7.5.2 Isolation (circuit shorts). A test voltage shall be applied between all common portions of each conductor pattern and all adjacent common portions of each conductor pattern. The test voltage shall be applied between conductor patterns of each layer and the electrically isolated pattern of each adjacent layer. For manual testing the test voltage shall be 200 volts minimum and shall be applied for a minimum of 5 seconds. When automated test equipment is used, the minimum applied test voltage shall be the maximum rated voltage specified. If the maximum rated voltage on the printed board is not specified, the test voltage shall be 40 volts minimum.

4.7.6 Environmental test methods.

4.7.6.1 Moisture and insulation resistance. The test for moisture and insulation resistance shall be performed in accordance with class 3 of test method number 2.6.3 of IPC-TM-650.

* 4.7.6.2 Thermal stress. The test for thermal stress shall be performed in accordance with condition A of test method number 2.6.8 of IPC-TM-650.

4.7.6.3 Thermal shock. The test for thermal shock shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.6.7.2 of IPC-TM-650 except that the temperature extremes shall be –65 degrees Celsius and +125 degrees Celsius.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirement. The requirement for packaging shall be in accordance with MIL-PRF-31032.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Notes. The notes specified in MIL-PRF-31032 are applicable to this specification.

6.1.1 Intended use. This specification sheet was developed for the use of verifying performance characteristics of multilayer (3 or more conductor layers) flexible and rigid-flex printed wiring boards with or without plated holes, that will use soldering for component/part mounting. Other flex or rigid-flex printed board technology types (such as single or double sided designs) can be verified to the requirements contained in this document, however, the performance parameters and baseline verification methods of other MIL-PRF-31032 performance specifications sheets may be more appropriate.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

* a. Title, number, revision letter, and date of this specification.

* b. The specific issue of individual documents referenced (see section 2).

* c. Title, number, and date of applicable printed board procurement documentation or drawing. Identification of the originating design activity and, if applicable, the Government approved deviation list for the printed board procurement documentation or drawing.

* d. The complete product procurement documentation part or identifying number (see 3.1).

* e. The printed wiring board type (type 3 or 4, see 1.2.1 and 3.1) and installation use classification (use A or B, see 1.2.2 and 3.1).

f. Title, number, revision letter (with amendment number when applicable), and date of the applicable design standard with performance classification.

g. Requirements for delivery of one copy of the quality conformance inspection data pertinent to the product inspection lot to be supplied with each shipment by the QML manufacturer, if applicable.

h. Requirements for certificate of compliance, if applicable.

i. Requirements for notification of change of product or process to the contracting activity in addition to notification to the qualifying activity, if applicable.

j. Levels of preservation and packing required.

* k. If special or additional identification marking is required (see 3.8).

6.2.1 Optional acquisition data. The following items are optional and are only applicable when specified in the printed board procurement documentation.

a. If any special or additional cleanliness is required (see 3.7.3.1 and 6.5.1).

b. Special requirements for bow and twist (see 3.7.4.3 and 6.5.2).

c. Special requirements for flex endurance (see 3.7.4.4).

d. Special requirements for folding flexibility (see 3.7.4.5).

e. The durability of coating rating (accelerated aging for solderability testing) if other than category 2 (see J-STD-003, 3.7.4.7).

f. Special requirements for electrical testing at the assembly level (see table I, footnote 3).

g. Requirements for failure analysis, corrective action and reporting of results.

h. Disposition of lot conformance inspection sample units.

i. Any other additional special requirements.

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* 6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Manufacturers List (QML 31032) whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from Defense Supply Center, Columbus, ATTN: DSCC/VQE, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43218-3990 or e-mail 5998_Qualifications@dscc.dla.mil.

* 6.4 Replacement information. This specification includes a majority of the performance requirements of previous revisions of MIL-P-50884 for types 3 and 4 printed wiring boards. Printed wiring boards conforming to this specification sheet would be comparable to printed wiring boards conforming to MIL-P-50884.

* 6.5 Blind or buried vias. This specification includes provisions for verifying the performance of type 4 rigid printed wiring boards.

6.6 Notes regarding optional cleanliness verification testing. This optional verification test is not listed in table I, Lot Conformance Inspection. If verification is required, the acquiring activity should specify acceptability requirements and test specimen sampling frequency.

6.7 Stiffener adhesion test and requirement. This document does not include the stiffener adhesion test or requirement contained in MIL-P-50884. All stiffeners are viewed as a mechanical support and total bonding of the stiffener to the printed wiring board is not required for compliance with this document.

* 6.8 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army - CR
Navy - EC
Air Force - 11
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Review activities:
Army - MI
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Preparing activity:
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